

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 195

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to recognize Shannon Blevins on her selection
as a 2024–2025 Kiwanis Club of Erwin Teacher
of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to
specially recognize those outstanding teachers who have devoted their careers to providing the
highest quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Shannon Blevins is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished
herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, a K-5 special education and comprehensive development classroom
teacher at Love Chapel Elementary School, Ms. Blevins was recently named by the Kiwanis
Club of Erwin as a 2024–2025 Teacher of the Year, a most befitting honor for her twenty-five-
year tenure as an educator, as it recognizes the positive influence she has on so many young
lives; and

WHEREAS, Shannon Blevins is an extremely talented and compassionate educator who
has worked assiduously throughout her career in education to motivate her students, fellow
teachers, and staff to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens; and

WHEREAS, a fixture of both professional and community organizations, Ms. Blevins is a
member of the National Education Association, serves as a member of Love Chapel Elementary
School's Lighthouse leadership team, and acts as a board member for The Arc of Washington
County, a nonprofit that assists adults with disabilities and provides various services to students
with disabilities; and

WHEREAS, an educator of educators, Ms. Blevins mentors new teachers in the Unicoi
County School System and for East Tennessee State University's special education program,

and she assists teachers in their certified restraint training, in addition to co-directing the STARS afterschool program; and

WHEREAS, an avid proponent for a socioemotional approach that caters to the whole person of a student, Ms. Blevins always desires to integrate academics, community, and extracurriculars, and while instilling that same love into those she guides and trains, she helps colleagues achieve greater success by helping to formulate individualized educational plan goals, complete reevaluation paperwork, and create resources that better facilitate student learning; and

WHEREAS, among Ms. Blevins's most cherished accomplishments was her collaboration at Unicoi County Middle School with the late Sharon Slagle to create the "Imagination Station Pre-K Parade" that united middle school and Pre-K students to foster a cohesive school culture and identity; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Blevins also commits her time, along with her sons, to the Handbell Choir at Centenary United Methodist Church, as well as lending her exceptional leadership skills to the church's Vision Team; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Blevins truly serves as an inspiration to the faculty, staff, and students at Love Chapel Elementary School, and her friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know her; and

WHEREAS, Shannon Blevins epitomizes the dedicated educator who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Shannon Blevins on being chosen as a 2024–2025 Kiwanis Club of Erwin Teacher of the Year, commend her

exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute her professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish her all the best in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.